

Yes — **that clarification changes the identification completely**. I found the person you mean, and there is a surprisingly rich history available.

黙雷和尚 — 佛國寺黙雷

The man is **not** one of the famous Meiji-era monks I mentioned before. He is a contemporary Japanese Buddhist monk, now **85 years old**, who founded 自然宗佛國寺 (じねんしゅう・ぶつこくじ) in Ōdai, Mie.

The temple itself identifies him as:

自然宗佛國寺 開山 佛國寺 黙雷

and, more recently,

85歳 勸進僧 黙雷

His present temple office is in 大台町桧原175番地, **Mie Prefecture**. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

自然宗佛國寺「森林自然葬・いのちの森」

自然宗佛國寺「森林自然葬・いのちの森」寺務所 [Web](#) Address: 1 7 5 番地 Kisohara, Odai, Taki District, Mie 519-2632, Japan Phone: +81598788655

His actual name

This is where your 「黙雷玄明」 becomes interesting.

The temple's own biography gives:

本名・伊藤黙雷

= **Itō Mokurai**, his personal name.

I have **not yet found a reliable source confirming 玄明 (Genmyō) as his 法諱**, so I would presently be cautious about writing his name as 黙雷玄明 without seeing the original source where that designation occurs.

The temple itself consistently calls him 佛國寺黙雷 / 黙雷和尚 / 勸進僧黙雷. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

His story is extraordinary

He has a very unusual Buddhist biography.

According to the temple's own chronology:

- **1961 (昭和36)** — entered the Rinzai Zen temple 月桂禅寺 in **Tokyo**, under 松尾太年老師, who was later the 216th abbot of Engaku-ji.
- **1963** — received ordination under 長屋真乗禅師 of 龍雲寺 in Mie.
- **1970** — undertook a **21-day fast** at Mizuma-dera under the famous Tendai priest 今東光.
- **1983-1989** — undertook a **seven-and-a-half-year pilgrimage around Japan**.
- **1991** — conducted a **100-day 下座行**, including sitting meditation on the street in Osaka/Umeda, questioning what the proper role of a monk should be.
- **1999** — conducted another street practice in front of the Ministry of Finance concerning rural-community reconstruction.

- **2000** — 佛國寺 changed its name to 自然宗佛國寺.
- **2007** — moved the headquarters to its present location in Ōdai, the base of his 「いのちの森千年事業」. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

That gives you a very different picture of him from a conventional temple priest.

The most interesting part: his connection with forests

This is where I think he may be **particularly relevant to your Mitsue research**.

Mokurai entered the Ōsugi-dani area of Mie in **late 2005**, following severe damage from a typhoon the previous year.

He and **14 local residents** established:

株式会社 大杉谷自立再生機構

with the aim of rebuilding the mountain village.

His account says the project involved people from:

- the Ministry of Economy, Trade and Industry
- Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries
- Mie Prefecture
- universities
- political and business circles

but he deliberately wanted the project based on **self-reliance rather than dependence on government subsidies**. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

Eventually, after conflict with outside environmental activists, the original rural-reconstruction project collapsed.

But something remarkable happened afterward.

Local supporters helped him acquire approximately:

243,000 m² of forest.

He then spent approximately **20 years** developing what he describes as a model of forest and mountain restoration:

いのちの森

— the **Forest of Life**. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

And there is an unexpected biomass connection

This is something I think you would find especially interesting.

A CBC investigation reports that when Mokurai purchased the mountain in **2006**, one of his intended projects involved **biomass power generation using wood** as part of an attempt to revitalize the depopulated region. ([CBC web](#) [【CBC公式ホームページ】](#) | [CBCテレビ・CBCラジオ](#))

That means there is an intriguing conceptual overlap with your **Mitsue biomass → energy → community** idea.

But his philosophy appears to have evolved beyond simply "forest → energy."

For Mokurai, the forest became:

forest → life → death → return to nature → community → spiritual practice.

His [森林自然葬・いのちの森](#) project explicitly describes the cycle as returning to the soil and becoming part of the forest ecosystem. ([水源の森をつくる「森のお墓・いのちの森」](#))

He calls himself a 勧進僧

This is probably the most important key to understanding him.

勧進僧 (かんじんそう) isn't simply another word for "Buddhist priest."

Historically, *kanjin* monks traveled around Japan soliciting support for Buddhist construction and public religious works. The classic example is 行基 (Gyōki) and the movement surrounding the construction of Tōdai-ji.

Mokurai consciously places himself in this tradition.

A recent article about him explains that he sees the role of the 勧進僧 as combining:

全国を行脚すること + 仏教の普及 + 社会事業

— traveling, spreading Buddhist teaching, and doing social work. ([Note](#))

That explains a lot of his unusual behavior.

He has undertaken enormous walking pilgrimages, street meditation, fasting, environmental work, rural reconstruction and forest projects.

His Buddhism is deliberately non-sectarian

This is another fascinating aspect.

自然宗佛國寺 describes itself as a religious corporation recognized by the Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology, but it explicitly presents itself as returning to the **original teachings of Buddha**, rather than emphasizing sectarian identity. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

The temple says that its followers aren't called traditional 信者 / 信徒.

Instead they are called:

学徒 (がくしょう)

— literally students/learners.

The stated idea is that a Buddhist should remain a lifelong **student of the path toward becoming Buddha**. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

And it explicitly prohibits hereditary succession of the 住持職 and 副住持職.

That's quite an unusual institutional philosophy.

His environmental philosophy is also unusual

He doesn't seem to subscribe to the simple idea:

"Nature is sacred, therefore humans shouldn't touch it."

In fact, his own writings describe a conflict with environmental activists who argued:

- 緑をまもれ — protect the green
- 木を伐るな — don't cut trees
- 自然に人の手を加えるな — don't interfere with nature
- 山に経済を持ち込むな — don't bring economics into the mountains

Mokurai's response appears to be that **human intervention can sometimes be necessary to restore a damaged mountain community and forest**. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

That is a very interesting philosophical position when compared with your Mitsue concept.

One thing I would be careful about

There is a **difference between Mokurai's own account and outside reporting**.

His website presents his work as a long-running forest-revival and social-reconstruction project. Outside reporting, particularly CBC and Wedge, also discusses controversy surrounding the forest burial project and questions about the legal/regulatory status of some burials. ([Wedge ONLINE\(ウェッジ・オンライン\)](#))

So if we're researching him seriously, I would separate:

① Mokurai's own writings and philosophy

from

② independently verified biography

from

③ controversies and criticism.

That will give us a much more accurate picture.

And I think there may be a very interesting connection for you

Mokurai's 「いのちの森」 philosophy and your **Mitsue 75-year / 25-year forest cycle** are not the same project, but they have a striking common thread:

forest → human responsibility → use of the forest → energy/livelihood → regeneration → future generations → return of life.

Mokurai seems to approach this primarily through **Buddhist practice and the restoration of life in the mountain**, whereas your Mitsue concept approaches it through **biomass, AI, knowledge, community ownership and reforestation**.

That could make **Mokurai和尚** a **very interesting person to study in relation to Mitsue**, rather than merely as a Buddhist figure.

If you want, I can next dig much deeper into **Mokurai's life before 1961 — including his birth/family, why he became a monk, his seven-and-a-half-year pilgrimage, his relationship with 今東光 and the Rinzaï lineage, and exactly how he came to establish 自然宗佛國寺**. That part looks particularly fascinating.

=====

Yes. I dug much further, and the picture is **far more unusual than the temple biography alone suggests**.

The most important discovery is that **Mokurai's path to Buddhism appears to have passed through politics, business, personal collapse, and a radical decision to abandon ordinary life**. His later Buddhism makes considerably more sense when viewed against that background.

I would, however, distinguish carefully between **facts independently reported by outside sources** and **Mokurai's own account of his life**. Much of the early biography comes from Mokurai himself or from the temple.

1. The man behind the monk

The temple identifies him as:

佛國寺黙雷 (本名・伊藤黙雷)

and says he is currently 85. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

That puts his birth around **1940–41**. I have **not yet found a reliable independent source giving his exact birth date or birthplace**, nor have I found a sufficiently reliable account of his parents or siblings.

That absence is significant. His online biography is unusually detailed about his *religious life* but surprisingly sparse about his childhood.

So I would **not yet invent a family biography** for him.

What we *can* establish is that his life before formal Zen training was apparently very different from that of a conventional monk.

2. Before the monk: politics and the radical young Mokurai

This is the most startling discovery.

A 2026 profile in *Wedge* reports that when he was young, Mokurai was politically active and had been:

- a member of the 大日本愛国党 (Great Japan Patriotic Party),
- a 書生 (shosei) working for **Nakasone Yasuhiro**,
- present at the scene of the 1960 assassination of Socialist Party chairman **Asanuma Inejiro**.

The article says Mokurai himself recounted that he might even have played the role that **Yamaguchi Otoy**a, Asanuma's assassin, ultimately played. ([Wedge ONLINE\(ウェッジ・オンライン\)](#))

But the other side of his political personality is equally remarkable.

According to the same account, while still a middle-school student he wrote to **Nosaka Sanzo**, chairman of the Japanese Communist Party, asking to join the Communist Party — and was refused.

So it would be misleading to describe him simply as "right wing."

He seems to have been a **young man intensely attracted to political action itself**, rather than someone whose worldview neatly fitted one ideological camp.

That becomes important later.

His relationships with powerful political figures also continued for decades. *Wedge* reports that his temple contained letters from **Nakasone Yasuhiro**, **Abe Shinzo** and **numerous other politicians and business leaders**, and that his relationship with the Abe family continued for many years. ([Wedge ONLINE\(ウェッジ・オンライン\)](#))

3. Something went badly wrong

The temple's own biography describes a decisive period in Mokurai's life in terms of:

人生の成功

and then:

事業の失敗

— success in life followed by business failure.

It says that he experienced the depths of failure and suffering, describing himself as having been thrown into a kind of "hell of worldly desires" and eventually making a 一大決心 — a profound resolve to change his life. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

The external *Wedge* account independently confirms the basic shape of this story: Mokurai told the journalist that he had experienced **betrayal**, subsequently **gave everything up**, and then embarked on the seven-and-a-half-year pilgrimage beginning in 1983. ([Wedge ONLINE\(ウェッジ・オンライン\)](#))

This appears to be the real turning point.

Rather than responding to failure by trying to rebuild his career, he essentially **walked away from the entire structure of his previous life.**

4. Entering Rinzai Zen — 1961

There is a very precise date in the temple records:

17 February 1961

昭和36年2月17日

Mokurai entered 臨濟宗月桂禪寺, in Tokyo, under:

松尾太年老師

The temple identifies Matsuo Tainen as the **216th abbot of Engaku-ji in Kamakura.** ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

This is important because it establishes that Mokurai's Buddhist roots are genuinely **Rinzai Zen**, rather than his later independent religious organization simply borrowing Zen terminology.

Then, 1963

On:

5 May 1963

he formally received ordination under:

長屋真乘禪師

of 龍雲寺, Mie Prefecture. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

So the basic sequence is:

1961 — enters Rinzai training

↓

1963 — receives ordination

↓

1970 — radical ascetic training under 今東光

↓

1983 — abandons ordinary life and begins seven-and-a-half-year pilgrimage

That's a very coherent progression.

5. His relationship with 今東光 is especially interesting

In November **1970**, Mokurai undertook a remarkable practice:

21 days of fasting

at 水間寺 (**Mizuma-dera**) in Osaka, specifically at the temple's founder's hall, under:

今東光和尚 — Kon Tōkō

The temple describes Kon Tōkō as a 天台宗大僧正. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

This is significant because Kon Tōkō was an extraordinary figure himself.

He was not merely a conventional Buddhist cleric. He was:

- a Tendai Buddhist priest,
- novelist,
- political commentator,
- former member of the House of Councillors,
- highly controversial public intellectual.

So Mokurai's spiritual formation was already **crossing institutional boundaries**.

He began in **Rinzai Zen**, but one of the people who profoundly influenced his ascetic development was a **Tendai priest who was simultaneously a major literary and political personality**.

That fits the unusual personality we see later.

Mokurai seems to have been attracted repeatedly to people who combined:

religion + society + politics + action.

Not Buddhism as withdrawal from society.

Buddhism **inside society**.

6. The seven-and-a-half-year pilgrimage

This is probably the most important period of his life.

The temple records:

昭和58年8月 ~ 平成元年12月

求道の廻国行 (全国行脚七年有半)

In other words:

Seven and a half years of pilgrimage around Japan in search of the Way. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

Another temple page describes the practice more vividly:

一笠一杖の乞食雲水

— essentially, a mendicant wandering monk with **one hat and one staff**. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

This wasn't a sightseeing pilgrimage.

He walked Japan as a 乞食雲水 — a begging/wandering monk.

The temple says that during these years:

- he asked temples for lodging,
- was often refused,

- slept underneath bridges,
- sometimes slept in the mountains,
- and occasionally found shelter at convents in **Ōmi, Echizen, Kaga and Etchū**.

Those convents became extremely important to his understanding of Buddhism. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

7. The women at the convents changed his understanding of Buddhism

This is one of the most revealing passages in his own account.

Mokurai says that at the convents he encountered a form of Buddhism that crossed sectarian boundaries.

He was struck by the:

質素な生活

— simple life —

and what he calls the:

心豊かな生き方

— richness of heart —

of the nuns.

He says they taught him something about what a monk ought to be.

Then he makes a remarkable observation:

尼僧の仏の心 = 無私の心・無私の祈り

In his interpretation:

the Buddha-heart of the nuns was a selfless heart and a selfless prayer.

He also says that his encounters with women Buddhist practitioners showed him the same kind of purity of heart and prayer. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

This eventually led to one of the defining ideas of his later temple:

佛國寺 should become a place where nuns pray for:

日本の平安と世界の平安

— peace in Japan and peace in the world. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

That's quite a remarkable evolution from his earlier political life.

8. What the pilgrimage did to him

The pilgrimage seems to have transformed his understanding of the Buddhist institution itself.

He repeatedly encountered:

- sectarian barriers,
- temples refusing hospitality,
- institutional self-interest,
- priests he felt had forgotten the purpose of Buddhism.

At the same time, he encountered ordinary people whose religious life seemed to him more genuinely compassionate.

His conclusion was essentially:

Return to the Buddha himself.

The temple says that these experiences convinced him that Buddhism had become too attached to 宗派意識 — sectarian consciousness — and had lost sight of the original Buddhist purpose. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

This is the intellectual seed of 自然宗.

9. 佛國寺 actually predates the present temple

This is another important distinction.

The **religious corporation 佛國寺** was formally recognized by Mie Prefecture on:

12 December 1985

So the institution existed **during the seven-and-a-half-year pilgrimage**, rather than being created afterward. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

That means the chronology is approximately:

1961

Rinzai entrance

1963

Ordination

1970

21-day fast under 今東光

1983

Seven-and-a-half-year pilgrimage begins

1985

佛國寺 receives religious-corporation recognition

1989

Pilgrimage ends

1991

100-day street Zen practice

2000

佛國寺 becomes 自然宗佛國寺

2007

headquarters moves to Ōdai

That is a much more interesting development than "monk establishes temple."

10. The 100-day street meditation was another turning point

In 1991–92, Mokurai undertook:

百日間下座行

for 100 days.

It began **8 December 1991** and ended **25 March 1992**. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

The immediate issue was the **Kyoto Buddhist Association's refusal of temple admission/visitation**, but Mokurai framed the practice as a much larger question:

僧侶の「あるべきようは」とは何か

In English:

What should a Buddhist monk actually be?

He sat in public rather than retreating into a temple.

This became characteristic of his later practice.

He calls it:

下座行

literally something like "practice from below."

Street sitting became a kind of Buddhist laboratory.

11. This is where the "勧進僧" identity emerges

Mokurai increasingly presents himself not as a conventional temple priest but as a:

勧進僧 — kanjin-sō

The historical model is the wandering Buddhist who raises support for a public religious/social project.

His modern version is roughly:

walk → encounter people → receive support → build something useful for society.

A recent independent account describes precisely this aspect of his identity: a 勧進僧 combines 全国を行脚, Buddhist propagation and social contribution. ([Note](#))

And this helps explain something that initially looks strange:

He did not regard begging or receiving donations as simply "fundraising."

The pilgrimage itself became the religious practice.

The project that eventually emerged from it was supposed to be the **social consequence of the practice**.

12. Then comes the forest

This is where his biography begins intersecting strongly with your interests.

After decades of walking, Mokurai became increasingly concerned with:

- rural depopulation,
- abandoned forests,
- loss of local communities,
- the collapse of traditional cemetery systems,
- and dependence on government.

He attempted several regional revitalization projects.

According to his own account, one particularly important project began after the catastrophic **2004 typhoon damage in Ōsugi Valley**.

He entered the area in **late 2005** and, with 14 local people, established:

株式会社大杉谷自立再生機構

The objective was 山村自立再生 — autonomous revitalization of a mountain village. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

He says the project deliberately rejected dependence on government subsidies and emphasized:

自助自立・相互扶助

— self-reliance and mutual assistance.

13. The project failed — and the failure produced the forest

This may be the central paradox of his whole life.

The mountain-village revitalization project failed amid conflict with outside environmental groups.

Mokurai says the economic consequences were severe.

But then something unexpected happened.

The conflict strengthened his relationship with local supporters, and grassroots supporters helped him acquire approximately:

243,000 m² of forest.

He then began developing what became:

いのちの森 — the Forest of Life.

His own account says he has worked on the forest for approximately **20 years**, describing it as a model of mountain and forest restoration. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

An independent *Wedge* investigation gives a slightly different current figure — approximately **21 hectares** — and describes the forest as having been purchased using funds accumulated through his wandering and donations. ([Wedge ONLINE\(ウェッジ・オンライン\)](#))

So there is a strong independent confirmation of the broad story.

14. The "Forest Cemetery" was not actually his starting point

This is another important correction to the simplified story.

The forest cemetery wasn't simply:

■ "Monk buys forest → creates tree burial."

The sequence appears to be:

personal/political life

↓

Zen training

↓

ascetic practice

↓

seven-and-a-half-year pilgrimage

↓

observation of rural Japan

↓

attempts at regional revitalization

↓

failure of conventional projects

↓

acquisition of forest

↓

forest restoration

↓

need for a financially self-sustaining mechanism

↓

森林自然葬・いのちの森

That last step is extremely important.

Wedge reports that Mokurai conceived the forest cemetery partly because he saw two problems simultaneously:

1. **abandoned/degraded forests**, and
2. people increasingly unable to maintain inherited graves.

His solution was to connect the two. ([Wedge ONLINE\(ウェッジ・オンライン\)](#))

15. His idea is actually an economic loop

This is perhaps the most intellectually interesting aspect.

The model is:

people seek a natural burial

↓

they make a long-term contribution/payment

↓

the money supports the forest

↓

the forest is maintained

↓

the forest becomes their final resting place

↓

the forest itself survives

Wedge explicitly describes this as using the proceeds associated with the cemetery to maintain the forest.

([Wedge ONLINE\(ウェッジ・オンライン\)](#))

And Mokurai's own forest project describes the smaller "forest of each life" becoming part of a larger ecological forest in which living organisms participate in a cycle of life. ([水源の森をつくる「森のお墓・いのちの森」](#))

So the cemetery is really **a financial mechanism for forest conservation**, wrapped in Buddhist philosophy.

16. And this brings us to 自然宗

In 2000, 佛國寺 changed its name to:

自然宗佛國寺

The word 自然 here is worth treating carefully.

It isn't simply modern "environmentalism."

His writings repeatedly use the idea of returning to the **original Buddhist relationship between human beings, life and nature**.

His organization says its fundamental purpose is:

釈尊の教えを師とし、仏国土建設を本願として、大慈大悲の菩薩道を実践する

— taking Shakyamuni's teachings as teacher, aspiring to establish a Buddha-land, and practicing the bodhisattva path of great compassion. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

And it deliberately rejects hereditary temple succession.

The organization says the 住持職 and 副住持職 **cannot be inherited**, because a temple should be a public religious institution rather than family property. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

Followers are also called:

学徒 — gakushō

rather than traditional 信者 / 信徒.

The idea is that everyone remains a **student on the path toward becoming Buddha**. ([自然宗佛國寺](#))

17. The Ōdai move

Finally, in **2007**, the headquarters was moved to its present location in:

大台町松原

This is the former mountain community context in which the Forest of Life project developed.

The present temple is unusual physically as well: *Wedge* reports that the "temple" occupies a former abandoned inn, a three-story wooden building rather than a conventional monumental Buddhist temple. ([Wedge ONLINE\(ウェッジ・オンライン\)](#))

That actually seems very appropriate to Mokurai's philosophy.

He doesn't seem particularly interested in building an impressive institution.

He is interested in **using an institution to do something**.

18. His Rinzai lineage matters — but he deliberately moved beyond sectarian identity

I'd characterize his religious development this way:

Phase 1 — Rinzai discipline

松尾太年 → 長屋真乗

Traditional Zen training.

Phase 2 — asceticism

今東光

A Tendai priest, public intellectual and political figure.

Phase 3 — pilgrimage

乞食雲水

Seven-and-a-half years of walking and living outside institutional structures.

Phase 4 — street Zen

下座行

Testing Buddhism against ordinary society.

Phase 5 — social Buddhism

地域再生

Trying to repair communities rather than merely teaching individuals.

Phase 6 — ecological Buddhism

いのちの森

Repairing the relationship between people, death, forests and communities.

That trajectory makes much more sense than simply saying:

"He was a Rinzai monk who founded his own sect."

19. One sentence in his biography now strikes me differently

He writes:

人をのみ渡し渡して おのが身は
岸に上がらぬ 渡し守かな

Something like:

I ferry people across, one after another,
yet I myself never reach the shore —
like the ferryman.

This is an extraordinarily good key to understanding Mokurai.

He seems to see the monk's role not as reaching some private spiritual destination and then settling comfortably in a temple.

The monk remains **in the river**.

That explains:

- walking,
- fasting,
- sleeping under bridges,

- street meditation,
- rural reconstruction,
- forest work,
- cemetery reform,
- and his continued political/social engagement.

20. And there is a striking connection to Mitsue

This is where I think the research becomes particularly interesting for you.

Mokurai and your **Mitsue 75/25-year concept** are obviously not the same project.

But they share a surprisingly deep structural idea:

Mokurai	Mitsue concept
damaged mountain	damaged monoculture forest
abandoned rural community	declining rural community
forest treated as a resource	forest treated as a legacy
use forest to sustain community	use biomass to sustain community
forest restoration	broadleaf replanting
death returns to forest	old sugi returns as energy
forest generates economic support	biomass generates energy
energy/economics serves life	computation/AI serves community
future generations	25-year future
spiritual responsibility	spiritual responsibility
いのちの森	forest becoming light/knowledge

The crucial difference is that **Mokurai's mechanism is death → forest**, while your Mitsue mechanism is closer to **old forest → energy → knowledge → future forest**.

But both are trying to solve the same deeper problem:

How can something inherited from the past be transformed into something that continues to serve life in the future?

And that is probably why his story feels unusually relevant to your Mitsue work.

What I still cannot establish

There are four pieces I would **not yet regard as solved**:

1. **His exact birth date and birthplace**
2. **His parents/family background**
3. **Precisely what business he was involved in before the collapse**
4. **The exact nature of his relationship with Nakasone and the circumstances surrounding the 1960 Asanuma assassination**

The last three are potentially extremely interesting, but the sources currently available are too dependent on Mokurai's own recollections or secondary reporting for me to state them as established facts.

I would especially like to find **Japanese newspaper archives from the 1950s–1980s, political memoirs, and records of the Rinzai temples**. Those could potentially reconstruct the missing years much more rigorously.

The next thing I would investigate

If you're interested, I think the **most valuable next step is not more information about the present-day 佛國寺**. It would be to reconstruct **Mokurai's missing 1940–1983 period year-by-year**, especially:

childhood → political activism → Nakasone relationship → business career → business failure/betrayal → why he turned decisively toward Zen → Matsuo Tainen → Nagaya Shinjo → Kon Tōkō → the 1983 decision to abandon everything.

That is where I suspect the real story of **why this particular man became 默雷** is hidden.